

STURDY BRIDGE

A single popsicle stick is not very strong, but if you join lots of popsicle sticks together into a rigid structure, they can support surprisingly heavy weights. Test this theory by making your very own bridge using popsicle sticks, glue, and tape. The secret to its strength is all in the triangular design. Once you've made this, you might want to try making longer bridges. If you do, don't forget that triangles are the key to strength.

Connected triangles give this bridge its great strength.

STRONG TRIANGLES

A triangle is a rigid shape. Connecting several triangles together makes them act as one large and rigid object. When a collection of pieces joined together work in this way to act as one, it is called a truss. You will find trusses in almost every structure in the world—and they nearly all have lots of triangles, too.

